MILITARY SPECIFICATION

POTASSIUM DINITROHYDROXY HYDROBENZOFUROXAN (For Use in Ammunition)

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers one type of potassium 4, 6-Dinitro-7-hydroxy-7-hydrobenzofuroxan, an initiating explosive, intended for use in ammunition (see 6.4).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids, or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes (ABC-STD-105)
MIL-STD-109	-	Quality Assurance Terms and Definitions
MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-650	-	Explosives: Sampling, Inspection and Testing
MIL-STD-1171	-	Acceptance and Description Sheets for Propellants and Explosives
MIL-STD-1235	-	Single and Multilevel Continuous Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

FSC: 1376

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(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activities or as directed by the Contracting Officer.)

2.2 Other publications.-The following document forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids shall apply.

CODE OF FEDERAL REGULATIONS

Title 49 - Transportation, Parts 0 - 190

(The Interstate Commerce Commission Regulations are now a part of the Code of Federal Regulations, available from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402. Orders for the above publications should cite, "49 CFR 0-190 (latest revision)".)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.-The KDNBF shall meet the requirements of this specification and shall have been tested within 90 days prior to shipment. The KDNBF shall be crystalline material having the empirical formula $C_6H_3N_4O_7K$ and shall conform to the physical/functional/chemical requirements which follow when determined as specified in applicable paragraphs of 4.4 (See 6.6). The manufacturing process shall use raw materials of no lesser purity than those specified in 6.5. The suggested process of manufacture is also given in 6.5.

3.1.1 Physical Properties

Test	Requirement	Applicable Paragraph
Color	Light Orange to Dark Red	4.4.1
Bulk Density, g/ml	0.2 min.	4.4.3

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3.1.2 Forms.-KDNBF shall be in the form of plate-like crystals (See figures 3 and 4) when determined as specified in 4.4.2. In addition, the dried KDNBF powder shall be easily dispersable in the functioning test described in 4.4.9.

3.1.3 Granulation.-The KDNBF shall conform to the granulation requirements of Table I when determined in accordance with 4.4.4.

TABLE I

Distribution U.S. Standard Sieves	Percent by Weight
Through a No. 50	98.0% (Min.)
Retained on a No. 100	4.0% (Max.)
Retained on a No. 200	10-75.0%
Retained on a No. 270	85.0% - 100.0%

3.1.4 Vacuum Stability.-The material when tested in accordance with the method specified in 4.4.5 shall not liberate more than 1.0 milliliter (ml) of gas.

3.1.5 Nitrogen.-The nitrogen content of the compound shall be 19.75 $\pm$ 0.20 percent, when determined as specified in 4.4.6.

3.1.6 Differential Thermal Analysis (DTA).-The DTA graph of the tested KDNBF sample shall show only one major exotherm and that exotherm shall occur between 210°C and 225°C when tested as specified in 4.4.7.

3.1.7 Nuclear Magnetic Resonance (NMR).-The NMR spectra of the tested KDNBF sample shall have five (5) distinct peaks one each at 5.77, 5.93, 6.13, 6.27 and 8.63 ppm. The average amplitude of the peaks at 5.93 and 6.13 ppm shall be greater then thirty (30) percent of the peak at 8.63 ppm. In addition, there shall be no peak at 9.22 ppm greater than five (5) percent of the peak at 8.63 ppm when tested in accordance with paragraph 4.4.8.

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3.1.8 Functioning test.--Ten (10) out of ten (10) plugs when subjected to the test described in 4.4.9 shall ignite (as indicated by commencement of pressure rise) within the limits of 1.0 - 1.2 milliseconds after flow of current through the bridgewire is started. In at least 9 out of the 10 plugs, 90 percent of the maximum pressure rise shall be obtained within 3.5 milliseconds. In the remaining plug 90 percent of the maximum pressure rise shall be obtained within 4.0 milliseconds. In seven (7) of the ten (10) plugs, the maximum pressure obtained shall be between 32.5 and 59.5 pounds per square inch/milligram/milliliter (psi/mg/ml). In the remaining three (3) plugs, the maximum pressure obtained shall be 27.0 psi/mg/ml, minimum. (NOTE: In case of failure a retest of twenty (20) additional plugs shall be made and all twenty plugs shall pass the requirement as described above.)

3.1.9 Solids content of supernatant storage liquid.--The solids content of the supernatant liquid in which the KDNBF is packaged shall not exceed 0.30 grams per 100 ml (0.3 g/100 ml) and 0.5 percent of the KDNBF contained therein when determined as specified in 4.4.10 (See 4.3.2).

3.2 Workmanship.--The material shall be processed in a manner that will produce the high quality material necessary to meet the requirements of this specification. The material shall be free of dirt, chips, and other foreign matter.

3.3 First article testing.--This specification makes provisions for first article testing. Submission of first article quantity by the contractor shall be as specified in the contract.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection.--Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such

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inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements. Reference shall be made to Standard MIL-STD-109 in order to define the terms used herein.

4.1.1 Submission of product.-At the time the completed lot of product is submitted to the Government for acceptance, the contractor shall supply the following information accompanied by a certificate which attests that the information provided is correct and applicable to the product being submitted:

a. A statement that the lot complies with all requirements and quality assurance provisions specified in this specification.
b. Specification number and date, together with an identification and date of changes.
c. Certificates of analysis on all materials used directly by the contractor when such material is controlled by Government specifications shall be made available upon request by the Contracting Officer.
d. Quantity of product in the lot.
e. Date submitted.

The certificate shall be signed by a responsible agent of the certifying organization. The initial certificate submitted shall be substantiated by evidence of the agent's authority to bind his principle. Substantiation of the agent's authority will not be required with subsequent certificates unless, during the course of the contract, this authority is vested in another agent of the certifying organization.

4.2 First Article Inspection

4.2.1 Submission.-The contractor shall submit a first article sample consisting of 20 grams of potassium 4, 6-dinitrobenzofuroxan in accordance with instructions issued by the Contracting Officer for evaluation in accordance with paragraph 4.2.2. All samples submitted shall have been produced by the contractor using the same production processes, procedures, and equipment as will be used in fulfilling the Contract. All materials, including packaging and packing, shall be obtained from the same sources of supply as will be used in regular production. The sample shall be accompanied by certificates of analysis. A first article quantity, or portion thereof, as directed by the Contracting Officer, shall also be submitted whenever there is a lapse in production for a period in excess of 90 days, or whenever a change occurs in manufacturing supply

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as to significantly affect product uniformity as determined by the Government. Prior to submission, the contractor shall inspect the sample to the degree necessary to assure that it conforms to the requirements of the contract and submit a record of this inspection with the sample. A sample containing known defects will not be submitted unless specifically authorized by the Contracting Officer.

4.2.2 Inspections to be performed.-The sample will be subjected by the Government to any or all of the examinations or tests specified in 4.3 and 4.4 of this specification and any or all requirements of the applicable drawings.

4.2.3 Rejection.-If any sample fails to comply with any of the applicable requirements, the first article quantity shall be rejected. The Government reserves the right to terminate its inspection upon any failure of a sample to comply with any of the stated requirements. In the event of rejection, the Government reserves the right to require the contractor to take corrective action and submit a new first article quantity or portion thereof. Until a first article quantity is accepted, the contractor is in no way authorized by the Government to resume regular production unless otherwise directed by the Contracting Officer.

4.3 Inspection Provisions

4.3.1 Lot formation.-The lot shall be one batch of KDNBF of the same type from one individual lot of dinitrobenzofuroxan produced by one manufacturer in accordance with the same specification, or same specification revision under one continuous set of operating conditions. Each batch (lot) shall consist of that quantity of KDNBF that has been subjected to the same unit chemical recrystallization process intended to make the final product homogeneous. The product shall be submitted for inspection in accordance with MIL-STD-105 (or Standard MIL-STD-1235 when applicable).

4.3.2 Sampling.-Select approximately a 20 gram sample of the KDNBF material after all processing procedures have been completed and the lot has been mixed and is ready for packaging. This sample shall be used for all tests depicted in 4.4 except 4.4.10. A sample of approximately 150 milliliters of the supernatant alcohol shall be removed from the packaged KDNBF no sooner than five (5) days prior to shipment and this sample shall be tested in accordance with 4.4.10. If the KDNBF sample or

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the alcohol sample fails to comply with any of the requirements specified in 3.1, the lot shall be rejected. (NOTE: Replace the methanol sample removed from the container with additional absolute methanol).

4.4 Test Methods and Procedures

4.4.1 Color, Major Defect, Defect Code No. 01001.-Take four (4) portions of about 2 mg each from the sample and spread the examination sample over an area of about 8 sq. cm. of glass slide. Examine the material for color under a magnifying glass using daylight illumination to determine compliance with 3.1.1.

4.4.2 Form, Major Defect, Defect Code No. 02001.-Examine the material prepared in 4.4.1 under a microscope using a magnification of 150X (100-300) and reflected light. Scan the slide to determine compliance with 3.1.2.

4.4.3 Bulk Density, Major Defect, Defect Code No. 03001.- The bulk density of the compound shall be determined in accordance with Method 201.2 of Standard MIL-STD-650 except that a 25 ml graduated cylinder and absolute methanol as the solvent shall be used.

4.4.4 Granulation, Major Defect, Defect Code No. 04001.-The slurry from 4.4.3 shall be used for this test. Select and weigh to the nearest .001 g the required (approximately 3 inch diameter) plastic sieves. Nest the series of sieves in increasing order of fineness with the coarsest sieve on top so that the material passing through a sieve is transferred directly to the next sieve in the series. Tape the joints between the sieves to make them air tight. Place the sieves on a sheet of No. 1 filter (fast) paper in a close fitting (approximately 90 mm) buchner funnel which is held in a 500 ml vacuum flask. Wet the assembly with 25 ml of methanol, turn on the vacuum and transfer the slurry (see 4.4.3) onto the No. 50 sieve. (NOTE: The slurry shall be thoroughly stirred before transfer). Continue to aspirate until the stack of sieves are nearly dry. Dry the sieves and contents in an oven at 75 ± 5°C to constant weight, cool in a desiccator and weigh. The portions retained or passed by the various sieves shall be weighed and the results shall be calculated as follows:

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$$\text{Retained, percent} = \frac{A+B}{W} \times 100$$

$$\text{Through, percent} = \frac{W-(A+B)}{W} \times 100$$

Where:
A = weight retained on designated sieve, in g.
B = weight retained on sieves nested above designated sieve in g
W = weight of sample, in g

4.4.5 Vacuum stability, Major Defect, Defect Code No. 05001.- The vacuum stability of the compound shall be determined at 120 + 0.5°C for 40 hours using the vacuum stability test described in Method 503.1 of MIL-STD-650.

4.4.6 Nitrogen, Major Defect, Defect Code No. 06001.-

4.4.6.1 Procedure.-Determine the nitrogen content using the Microchemical (Dumas) Method appearing in a standard or reference chemical instrumentation textbook. (See 6.8)

4.4.7 Differential Thermal Analysis (DTA), Major Defect, Defect Code No. 07001.-Determine the DTA graph of a sample of the material using the DuPont 950 Differential Thermal Analyzer or equivalent under the following conditions and settings:

Reference: Glass beads
Atmosphere: Helium at 100 ml/minute
Rate: 10°C/minute
T: 50°C/inch
ΔT: 0.2°C/inch

The method used requires prior approval from the Contracting Officer.

4.4.8 Nuclear Magnetic Resonance (NMR), Major Defect, Defect Code no. 08001.-Determine the NMR spectrum of a sample using a Varian Model T60 spectrometer or equivalent under the following conditions:

Sweep Offset (Hz) = 50	Sweep Width (Hz) = 500
Spectrum Amplitude = 50	Filter = 1 or 2
Spinning Rate (rps) = 37-41	RF Power Level = .075
Sweep Time (sec) = 250	

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4.4.8.1 Measure the amplitude at 5.93, 6.13, 8.63 and 9.22. Calculate the average percent amplitude of the peaks at 5.93 and 6.13 as follows:

$$\text{Amplitude, percent} = \frac{\text{amplitude } 5.93 + \text{amplitude } 6.13}{(\text{amplitude } 8.63) \times 2} \times 100$$

Calculate the percent amplitude at 9.22 ppm as follows:

$$\text{Amplitude, percent} = \frac{\text{amplitude } 9.22}{\text{amplitude } 8.63} \times 100$$

4.4.9 Functioning Test, Major Defect, Defect Code No. 09001.-

4.4.9.1 Preparation of Materials

4.4.9.1.1 Nitrocellulose (N/C) lacquer.-The N/C lacquer shall be formulated as follows:

N/C Lacquer	Percent by Weight
Camphor, USP	0.85
N/C, MIL-N-5538, 0.5 sec. viscosity	2.26
N/C, commercial, 60-80 sec viscosity	1.21
Butyl Acetate, TT-B-838	19.31
Ethanol, 3A denatured	58.87
Toluene, ACS grade	17.50

4.4.9.1.2 Bridge wire spotting mixture.-Weigh out 0.250 ± .001 gram of KDNBF in a 10 ml teflon beaker. Add exactly 0.634 ± .001 gram of the nitrocellulose lacquer. (See 4.4.9.1.1). Stir with a thin wooden dowel (wooden applicator of stick-test type) using a slow circular motion until a smooth lump free suspension is formed.

4.4.9.2 Dry ten (10) plugs shown in figure 2 to constant weight at 75 ± 5°C. Individually weigh each plug to the nearest .0001 gram. Apply the bridge wire spotting mixture (see 4.4.9.1.2) to the bridge wire of each plug to form a compact rounded spot (see 6.1). Air dry the plugs for 1 hour and then dry in an oven at 75 ± 5°C to constant weight. Remove the plugs, cool in a desiccator and weigh. The individual weights of the spots shall be between 2 mg to 4 mg.

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4.4.9.3 Procedure.-Each plug shall be fired with a current between 0.95 and 1.1 amperes in a 1 ml ± 0.10 ml volume pressure bomb similar to that shown in figure 1. Use a dual beam oscilloscope or equivalent and record the current in amperes, the time from start of current flow to commencement of pressure rise, time to 90% of maximum pressure, and the maximum pressure developed. Calculate the maximum pressure per mg of KDNBF per ml of bomb volume (psi/mg/ml) as follows:

$$\text{psi/mg/ml} = \frac{\text{Pmax} \times V}{W}$$

Where:
Pmax = maximum pressure
W = weight of KDNBF
V = volume of bomb

(NOTE: If this sample fails to meet the requirements given in 3.1.8, an additional twenty (20) plugs shall be retested. (See 3.1.8).

4.4.10 Solids content of supernatant storage liquid, Major Defect, Defect Code No. 10001.-Filter 100 ml of the supernatant liquid (see 4.3.2) through a No. 1 filter (fast) paper into an evaporating dish which has been dried to constant weight and weighed to the nearest 0.0001 gram. Allow the methanol to evaporate at a temperature not exceeding 40°C. Dry the dish and contents to constant weight at 75° ± 5°C and weight to the nearest 0.0001 gram. Record the gain in weight as grams of solids per 100 ml of alcohol. Calculate the percent total solids content of the supernatant liquid based on the KDNBF as follows:

$$\text{Percent total solids} = \frac{V}{W} \times \frac{\text{grams of solids}}{100 \text{ ml}}$$

Where:
V = total volume of supernatant liquid, in ml
W = total weight of KDNBF (dried), in g

(NOTE: Use the total volume (V) of the supernatant liquid and the total weight (W) of the KDNBF (dried) marked on the container. (See 5.2) If the total volume of the alcohol and the total weight of the KDNBF is not known then these values shall be determined in order to run this analysis.)

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packing

5.1.1 Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, KDNBF shall be packaged in absolute methanol and in non-returnable methanol-impervious plastic containers of such a size that at least 750 ml but not more than 2000 ml of absolute methanol can be added for each pound (454 ± 5g) of KDNBF contained therein. The size of the container shall be such that after adding KDNBF plus alcohol it shall be completely full. Provisions shall be made to insure complete wetting of the KDNBF with the absolute methanol. (See NOTE) The KDNBF shall be shipped in accordance with paragraph 173.86 of the Department of Transportation Rules and Regulations for Transportation of Explosive and Other Dangerous Articles by Land and Water.

NOTE: Containers shall be completely sealed to afford maximum protection against evaporation of the alcohol and against water pick up. They shall be fitted with a non-screw-thread closure which is liquid tight. The closure shall be fastened with methanol-impervious nonmetallic tie, heat-shrunk film or by other suitable methods to prevent accidental dislodgement of the closure.

5.2 Marking.-In addition to any special markings required by the contract or purchase order, containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. The total volume (ml) of the alcohol and the total weight (g) of the KDNBF (dried) shall be marked on each container. Furthermore, marking shall include, but not be limited to, the following information:

a. Manufacturers name.
b. Product designation.
c. Lot number.
d. Date of manufacture.
e. Number of this specification.

6. NOTES

6.1 Bridgewire plugs (see 4.4.9.2) required for this test will be furnished by PA, upon request.

6.2 Ordering data.-Procurement documents should specify the following:

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a. Title, number and date of this document.
b. Description sheets shall be prepared for each lot in accordance with Standard MIL-STD-1171.
c. Provisions for submission of first article samples.

6.3 Inspection code numbers.-The five-digit code numbers assigned to the inspection herein are to facilitate future data collection and analysis by the Government.

6.4 Intended use.-The material covered by this Specification is intended to be used in explosive actuated devices and squib switches.

6.5 Process of Manufacture

6.5.1 Raw Materials and Intermediate Compounds

a. Ortho-Nitroaniline (O-NA) - MP 70°C minimum.
b. Sodium or Potassium Hydroxide - ACS grade.
c. Sodium Hypochlorite - Household bleach or equivalent.
d. Methanol, absolute, ACS grade.
e. Concentrated Sulfuric Acid - 95-98 percent ACS grade.
f. Concentrated Nitric Acid - 90 percent minimum, ACS grade.
g. Potassium Bicarbonate - ACS grade.
h. Potassium Carbonate - ACS grade.
i. Acetone - ACS grade.
j. Benzofuroxan (BF) - MP 67°C minimum.
k. 4, 6 Dinitrobenzofuroxan (DNBF) - MP 166°C minimum.

6.5.2 Procedure (Advisory)

6.5.2.1 Oxidation of O-NA to BF.-Oxidize the O-NA in methanol in the presence of strong concentrations of sodium or potassium hydroxide using approximately 5 percent sodium hypochlorite solution. Reaction temperatures can be between 5° and 40°C but shall not exceed 40°C to prevent eutectic melting of BF and methanol. The resultant BF shall have a melting point (capillary melting point apparatus) range at some point between 67°C minimum and 70°C maximum. BF may be recrystallized from methanol, if necessary.

6.5.2.2 Nitration of BF to DNBF.-Nitrate the BF dissolved in 10 parts concentrated sulfuric acid with mixed acid (i.e.,

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nitric acid/sulfuric acid in ratio between 1:1 and 1:4) at temperatures between 0°C and 20°C. At the end of addition of the nitrating acid the mixture may be heated up to 50°C momentarily but shall be immediately quenched on ice after attaining that temperature. Thd DNBF shall have a melting point range at some point between 166°C and 173°C. Typically, the washed product of nitration has a melting point range of 166-170°C, determined in a capillary melting point apparatus. The DNBF may be recrystallized from glacial acetic acid or methanol, if necessary. Successive recrystallizations yield DNBF with a melting point of 172-173°C.

6.5.2.3 Reaction of DNBF to KDNBF.-DNBF is suspended or dissolved in water to which has been added from 20 to 50 percent of methanol or acetone. The reaction with potassium bicarbonate is carried out at temperature of 40°C or below to prevent as far as possible hydrolysis of the product KDNBF. Unless conditions or ingredients are closely controlled the initial reaction yields a product which is difficult to wash and dries to a hard caky mass. The crude KDNBF should be recrystallized from water to yield a product which is acceptable. Some hydrolysis decomposition product will form during recrystallization and the product will require sufficient washings with methanol to meet requirements of 3.1.

6.6 This requirement is intended for procurement of bulk KDNBF only. End item specification may include test requirement for materials older than 90 days.

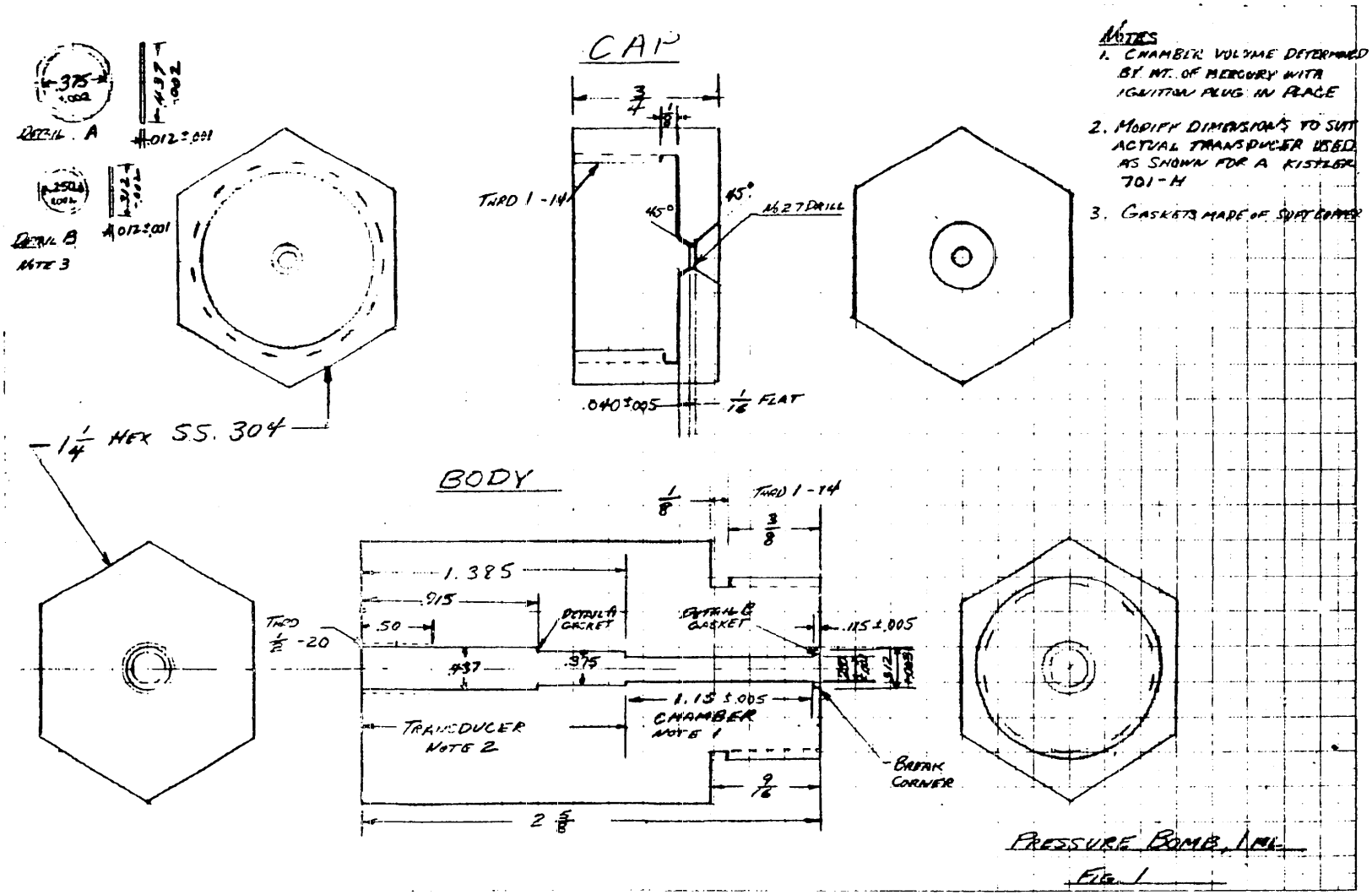
6.7 An acceptable procedure is described by Al Steyermark, Quantitative Organic Micro-Analysis, Academic Press, New York, 1961.

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Project Number: 1376-A-055

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PRESSURE BOMB, ASSY.

Fig. 1

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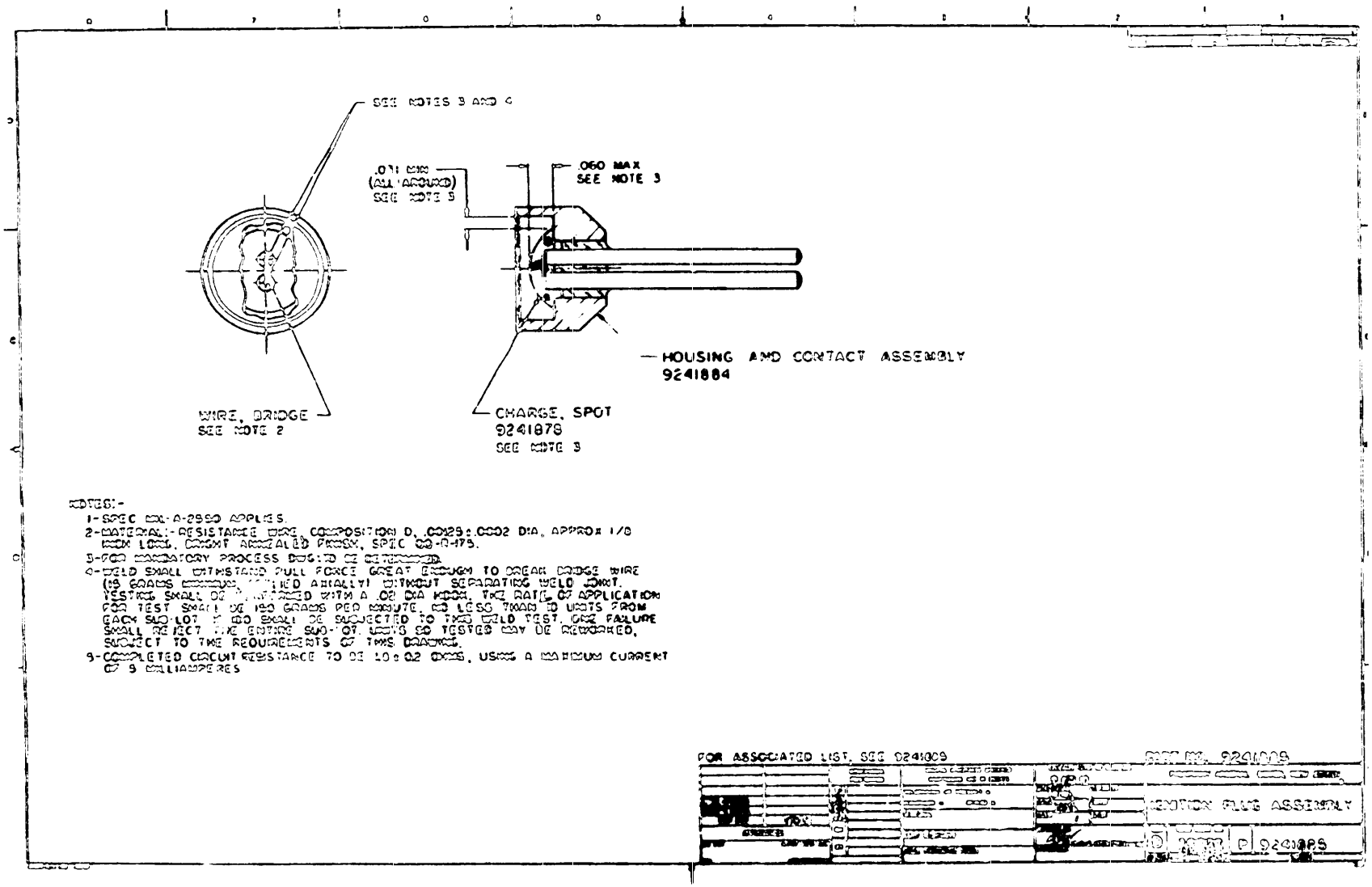


FIGURE 2

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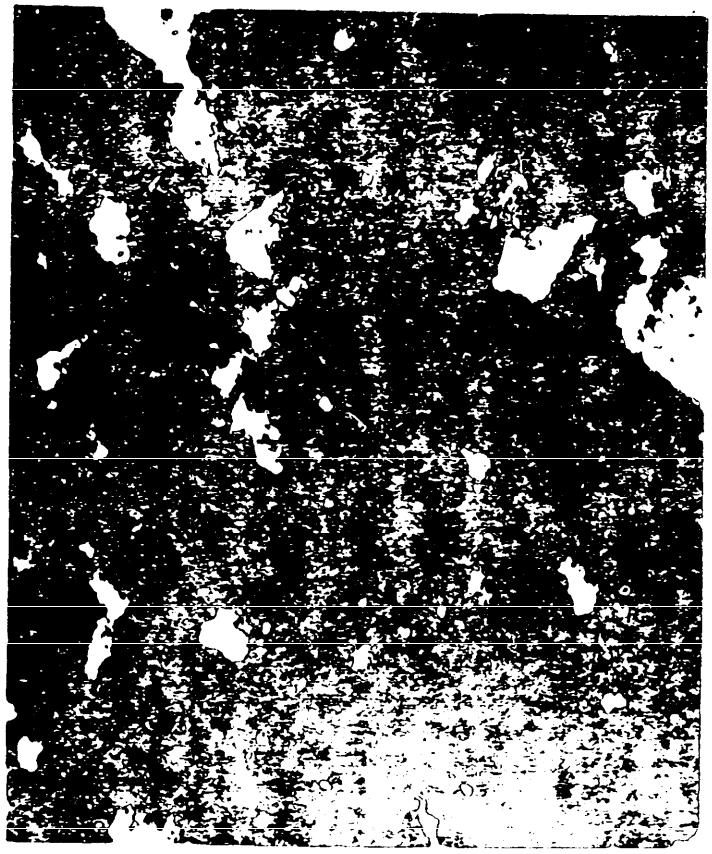


FIGURE 3

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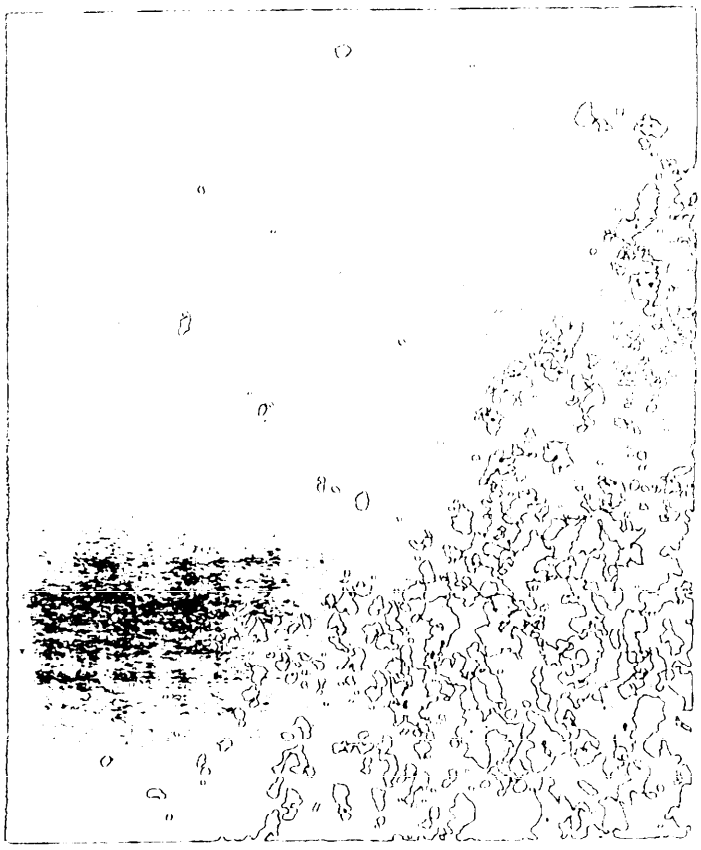


FIGURE 4

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SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

Form Approved
Budget Bureau No. 119-R004

INSTRUCTIONS

This sheet is to be filled out by personnel either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity.

SPECIFICATION

ORGANIZATION | CITY AND STATE

CONTRACT NO. | QUANTITY OF ITEMS PROCURED | DOLLAR AMOUNT $

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO IF "YES", IN WHAT WAY?

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity)* | DATE

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